What the town knows

ALL HALLOWS' EVE, 1924

The masquerade was the talk of Manchester, right up until the music stopped. The orchestra slipped in by the river door. Four masked guests slipped up to the private landing. By midnight the papers were screaming massacre, and nobody could find a body, a name, or a coroner willing to sign for one. The proprietress, Miss Cassie Castello, had vanished with the last dance.

TONIGHT

The black envelopes came to your door, signed by nobody you would dare name. You came anyway. Curious. A little reckless. Wear it well. Before the night is through, someone will be found dead, and the rest of you will have opinions.

FIVE SURVIVORS IN THE ROOM

Five souls the papers swore were lost in 1924 are here tonight in borrowed names and borrowed faces, sipping your drinks and watching your hands. They are guests like you. Before the lights come up you may point at up to five of your fellow guests and say survivor. Be right and it pays. Be wrong and it stings.

LAST CALL

You will be asked three things: what really happened in 1924, who did it tonight and how, and who the dead man is.

A WORD TO THE SURVIVORS

If you are one of the five, your private page already knows. Everyone else's has the same sealed flap with nothing behind it. Nobody can tell by looking. Keep a straight face. Everyone’s objectives are released at the start of the game, and the survivors find out who they are at the same moment.

The rules of the night

1. Your card has three tabs. Public is what everyone knows. Background is your history and what to wear. Private is yours alone: your secrets, your five errands, and anything you must not say aloud.
2. From 8:00 the room is a cocktail party. Mingle, trade, bargain. Errands earn you points; so do the pages and clues you find.
3. Later in the evening a body will be found. There is no town hall and no host to rule on anything. Question whom you like. Nobody is forced to answer.
4. Nothing is ever taken from anyone. Props change hands by a deal, and nobody brings anything: whatever you carry is handed to you at the door. Hidden game pieces are only in shared rooms, never in bedrooms, bathrooms, closets or drawers.
5. Walk, do not run, and keep your drink in your hand.
6. Type your answers into your phone whenever you like, and as often as you like. Only your last answer to each question counts. The site will not tell you whether you were right; nobody will, until the end.
7. The book closes at the end of the night. Points come from your errands, the pages you file, the survivors you name, and above all the three mysteries: the Old, the New and the Connection. Finish every errand and never work out the story and you cannot win.

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